



Anatomical Terminology of the Trunk

Module 1

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Define the trunk and its major subdivisions
- Use regional terms for trunk structures
- Apply directional terms within the trunk
- Relate planes, cavities, and surface landmarks

WHAT IS TRUNK?

Included regions

- Thorax
- Abdomen
- Pelvis
- Perineum
- Back

Boundaries

- Inferior to the neck
- Superior to the lower limbs
- Between the upper limbs
- Central axis of the body

Region	Anatomical meaning	Example structures
Thoracic	Chest region	Ribs, sternum, lungs, heart
Abdominal	Between thorax and pelvis	Stomach, liver, intestines
Pelvic	Inferior trunk within pelvis	Bladder, rectum, reproductive organs
Perineal	Inferior surface of pelvic floor	External genital and anal regions
Dorsal	Posterior trunk or back	Vertebral column, back muscles

ANTERIOR AND POSTERIOR LANDMARKS

- Anterior Trunk

- Sternal: over the sternum
- Pectoral: chest
- Mammary: breast
- Umbilical: around the navel
- Inguinal: groin

- Posterior Trunk

- Vertebral: spinal column
- Scapular: shoulder blade
- Lumbar: lower back
- Sacral: between the hips
- Gluteal: buttock

DIRECTIONAL TERMS IN THE TRUNK

Position and level

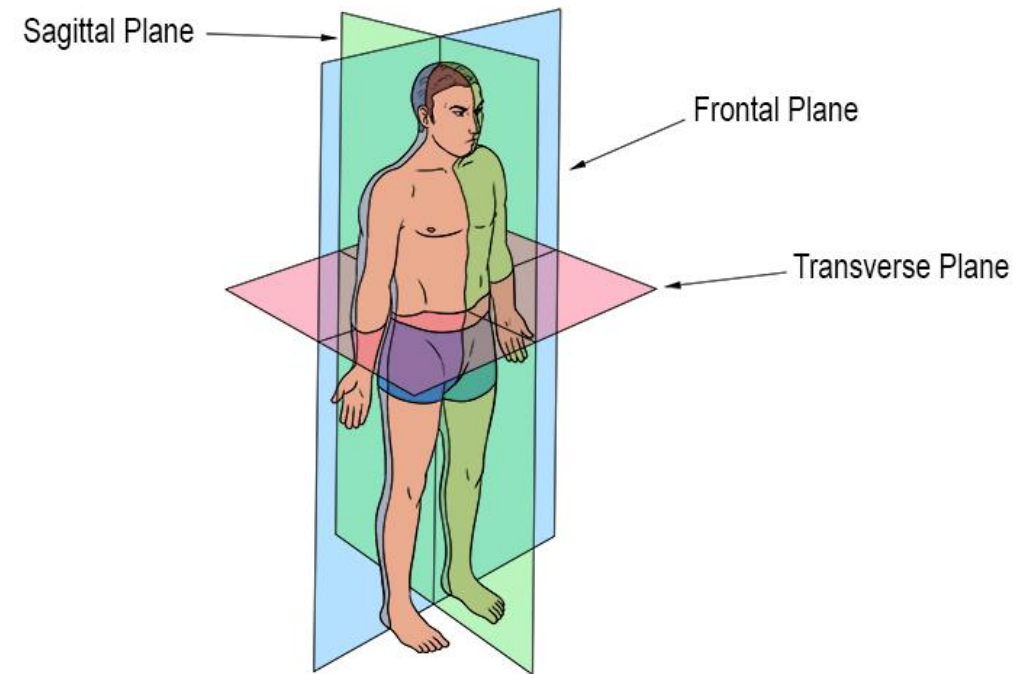
- Superior / inferior
- Anterior / posterior
- Medial / lateral
- Ipsilateral / contralateral

Depth and relationship

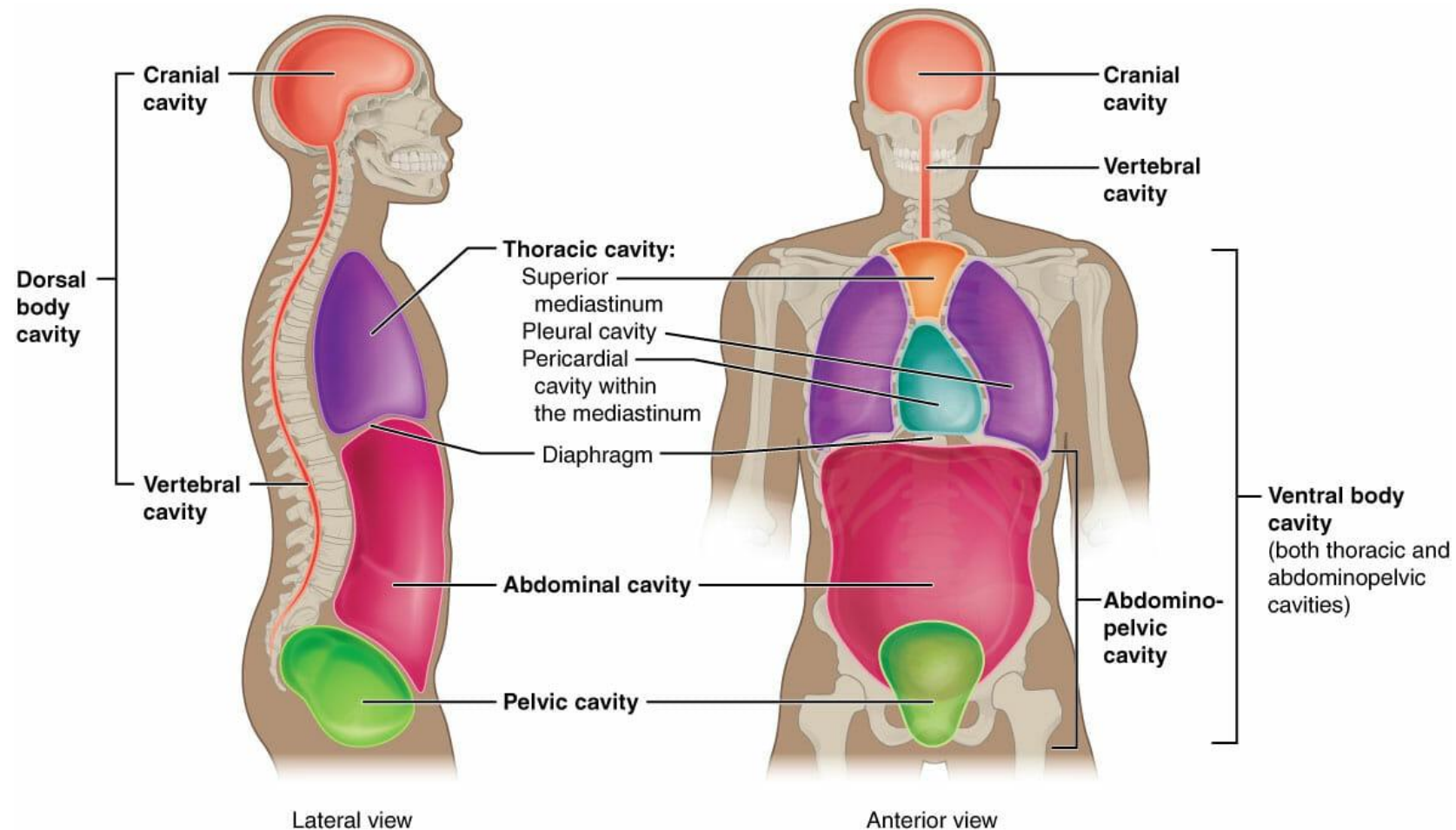
- Superficial / deep
- Internal / external
- Proximal / distal
- Parietal / visceral

ANATOMICAL PLANES THROUGH THE TRUNK

- Median plane: equal right and left halves
- Sagittal plane: parallel right and left sections
- Coronal plane: anterior and posterior sections
- Transverse plane: superior and inferior sections
- Oblique plane: angled section through the trunk



BODY CAVITIES OF THE TRUNK



SEROUS MEMBRANES TERMINOLOGY

Parietal Layer

- Lines the cavity wall
- Parietal pleura
- Parietal pericardium
- Parietal peritoneum

Visceral Layer

- Covers an organ surface
- Visceral pleura
- Visceral pericardium
- Visceral peritoneum

REFERENCES

1. Clinically Oriented Anatomy, by Moore & Dalley, 9th ed., 2024, LWW
2. Gray's Anatomy for Students, by Drake, et al, 4th ed., 2019, Elsevier
3. Atlas of Human Anatomy, by F. Netter, 8th ed., 2014, Saunders (Elsevier)